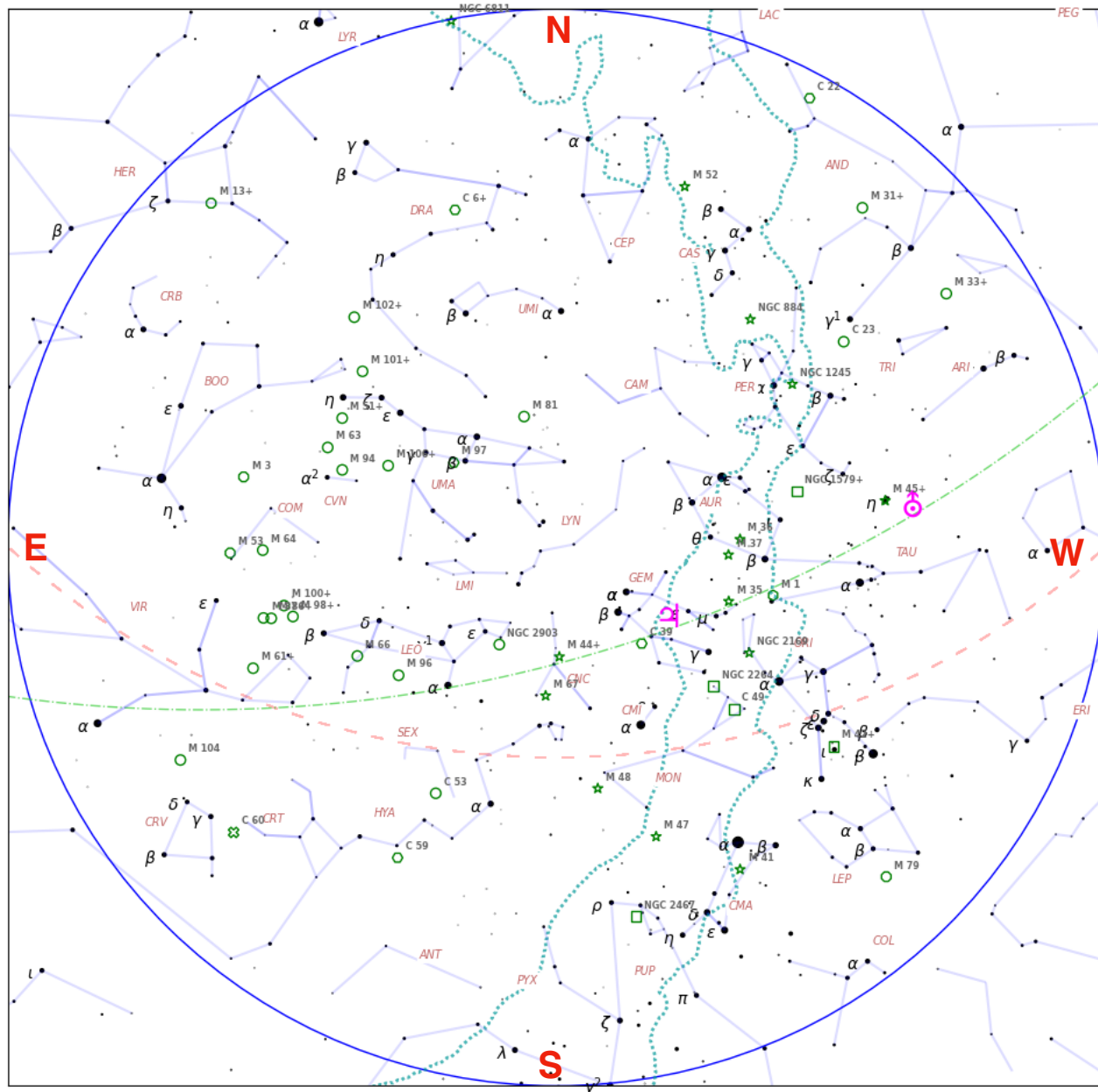


MARCH 2026



The Northern Berkshire Astronomical Society

Meets the first Wednesday of every month, at the
North Adams Public Library at 6 PM.

74 Church St. North Adams MA

Spring Arrives (finally)!

The Winter Milky Way is now in the West, with the springtime constellations returning in the East. Now there's a great variety of deep-sky objects to observe: clusters, nebulae, and galaxies are all within reach!

Constellations

AND - Andromeda - *the Chained Maiden*
 ANT - Antlia - *the Air Pump*
 ARI - Aries - *the Ram*
 AUR - Auriga - *the Charioteer*
 BOO - Boötes - *the Herdsman*
 CAM - Camelopardalis - *the Giraffe*
 CAS - Cassiopeia - *the Queen of Ethiopia*
 CEP - Cepheus - *the King of Ethiopia*
 CMA - Canis Major - *the Greater Dog*
 CMI - Canis Minor - *the Lesser Dog*
 CNC - Cancer - *the Crab*
 COL - Columba - *the Dove*
 COM - Coma Berenices - *Berenices' Hair*
 CRB - Corona Borealis - *the Northern Crown*
 CRT - Crater - *the Cup*
 CRV - Corvus - *the Crow*
 CVN - Canes Venatici - *the Hunting Dogs*
 DRA - Draco - *the Dragon*
 ERI - Eridanus - *the River*
 GEM - Gemini - *the Twins*
 HER - Hercules - *Hercules*
 HYA - Hydra - *the Water Snake*
 LAC - Lacerta - *the Lizard*
 LEO - Leo - *the Lion*
 LEP - Lepus - *the Hare*
 LMI - Leo Minor - *the Lesser Lion*
 LYN - Lynx - *the Lynx*
 LYR - Lyra - *the Harp*
 MON - Monoceros - *the Unicorn*
 ORI - Orion - *the Hunter*
 PEG - Pegasus - *the Winged Horse*
 PER - Perseus - *the Hero*
 PUP - Puppis - *the Stern (of Argo)*
 PYX - Pyxis - *the Mariner's Compass*
 SEX - Sextans - *the Sextant*
 TAU - Taurus - *the Bull*
 TRI - Triangulum - *the Triangle*
 UMA - Ursa Major - *the Great Bear*
 UMI - Ursa Minor - *the Lesser Bear*
 VIR - Virgo - *the Virgin*

How to Use the Chart

South is at the bottom, if you hold the chart “up” against the sky, facing South, then East will be to your left and West to the right. (Or if you hold the map upside-down and face North, East will be to the right, West to the left.)

On the chart, the orange dashed line shows the celestial Equator; the green dashed-dotted line the Ecliptic. The Milky Way is outlined with a blue dotted line.

Date	Time
Mar 1	10:00 PM (EST)
Mar 8	10:30 PM (EDT)
Mar 15	10:00 PM
Mar 22	9:30 PM
Mar 29	9:00 PM

Because of the Earth's motion around the Sun, the time for this chart changes slowly over time, roughly 1/2 hour earlier every week:

Planets

Mercury and **Mars** are close to the Sun this month.

Venus returns to the evening sky, though setting shortly after the Sun, but climbing higher every week into the Summer.

Jupiter in Gemini, close to the meridian in the evening hours, and setting before sunrise.

Saturn and **Neptune** are in Pisces, and now behind the Sun.

Uranus is in Taurus, near the Pleiades - setting around midnight.